

Clean Water and Hygiene

Poor hygiene and unsafe water make people sick. Talk with families and lead village action to make water and sanitation safe.

For health workers

Key messages

- Teach handwashing at five key times: after the toilet or cleaning a child, before cooking, before feeding children, before eating, and before breastfeeding.
- Teach that clear water is not always safe. Boiling is a local way to treat water.
- Help families find local options for safe water, and for safe toilets and rubbish pits.
- Show how to build a tippy tap for handwashing with running water.

- In dialogue with families, ask how germs get from pekpek to the mouth, and what they can do to stop it.
- Mobilise the village to act on water, toilets and rubbish, using the community action steps.

Tell the health facility if

- Many people have diarrhoea at the same time
- A child has bloody diarrhoea or diarrhoea for 14 days or more
- The village has no safe water

Run a village session

1. Meet in a shaded, central place at a time when families can come. Greet everyone and say what today's topic is.
2. Ask what people already know and what they have heard. Listen first.
3. Share three key messages from this page in your local language. Use pictures and real examples from the village.

4. Ask people to say the messages back in their own words, and answer questions.
5. Agree on one action the village will take this month. Refer anyone who is unwell, and record who came.

General information only. Follow the advice of your health centre and current national guidelines. Based on the National Department of Health Village Health Assistant (VHA) training curriculum.